MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 14

"Little White Lies"

Episode 2x14. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x14. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Friday, January 20, 2006, 5:48 AM through 11:58 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 41 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x13

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Friday, January 20, 2006). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Friday, January 20, 2006)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	27
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	Patient: Status 1A, day 70 (CVICU)	Aug 8, 1971	34
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern	Jun 11, 1978	27
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (37 weeks 2 days pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Mrs. Henrietta Bolden (new)	Patient: atypical chest pain, facing eviction	Jun 3, 1917	88
Fulton Reese (new)	Patient: three-vessel CAD, active smoker	Sep 1, 1944	61
Vernice Reese (new)	Fulton's wife	Apr 4, 1946	59
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Shanice Ward (new)	Patient, age 15: ruptured ectopic pregnancy	Aug 22, 1990	15
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	OB/GYN and Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	34
Tiffany Royal (new)	Patient: psychogenic nonepileptic seizures	Nov 13, 1981	24
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Bernadette 'Bernie' Watkins	Executive Assistant to the Chief	Jun 6, 1950	55
Renee Ward (new)	Shanice's mother; home attendant	Mar 3, 1967	38
Hattie 'Miss Hattie' Lomax	Cafeteria	Mar 3, 1945	60
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Nurse Yvette Banks	CVICU Charge Nurse	Dec 1, 1963	42
Celia Montague, LCSW	Hospital Social Worker	May 6, 1966	39
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Lillian Divine	Harmony's mother	Feb 14, 1952	53
Howard Divine	Harmony's father	Aug 30, 1950	55
Mercy	The House's pit bull puppy	Sep 30, 2005	0

Also appearing: an elderly lung cancer patient and his son and daughter, a nurse, a registration clerk, a livery cab driver, and the EMU staff. Mentioned: James Frey, Oprah Winfrey, Dr. Harold Bynum, Dr. Delphine A. Ware (d. 2003), R. Adebayo, Esq., Augustin Toussaint, Jerry and Ronnie

Divine, Dr. Hampton, Glenda Duvall and Malcolm Sloan.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - PRE-DAWN
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 5:48 AM

The counter TV plays a morning show: a photo of a scruffy author beside the cover of a bestselling memoir, "A MILLION LITTLE PIECES," with an Oprah's Book Club sticker on it. The chyron: "'A MILLION LITTLE LIES'? MEMOIR UNDER FIRE." Harmony (26), in her robe, holds the actual book in one hand and her coffee in the other, glaring at the screen.

HARMONY
(furious)
I cried, Marc. (beat) On the 7 train. (beat) Page two-twelve. (beat) The root canal with no Novocain. (beat) I cried in front of a man selling churros.

MARC
(pouring cereal)
It might still be true.

HARMONY
(beat)
The Smoking Gun says he was in jail for five hours. (beat) Not eighty-seven days. (beat) Five hours. (beat) My mother bought copies for her whole Bible study.

AMOND
(from the table, not looking up from his data)
Everybody lies, Double-O. (beat) The only question is about what.

MARC (V.O.)
Patients lie to doctors. It's the first thing they teach you.

Mercy, now nearly four months old, trots in carrying a single shoe in her mouth. A woman's sneaker. Raven's.

HARMONY
(beat)
Where's Raven?

MARC
(beat, too quickly)
Gym.

AMOND
(beat, finally
looking up)
Raven doesn't go to a gym.

MARC (V.O.)
What they don't teach you is how
often doctors lie right back.

2 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - PRE-DAWN
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 6:09 AM

The CVICU in early-morning blue light. Dash (34) sits up in bed, thinner, an amiodarone drip and a milrinone drip running into his PICC, defibrillator pads still stuck to his chest. On the whiteboard: "DAY 70." Raven (26), in her street clothes and coat, an hour before her shift, sits in the chair beside him with two cups of coffee. One is decaf. His.

DASH
(sipping)
This is decaf.

RAVEN
(beat)
You've been shocked twice this
month. (beat) You get decaf.

DASH
(beat, grinning)
Six a.m., every day this week.
(beat) Your shift starts at
seven. (beat) Does Problem know
you come here first?

Raven looks at her coffee.

RAVEN
(beat)
She thinks I go to the gym.

DASH
(beat, setting down the cup)
You don't have a gym, Raven.

RAVEN
(beat)
I know.

DASH
(beat, softer)
You lied to her. (beat) For me.

MARC (V.O.)
We lie to make people feel better. We lie to buy time. (beat) We lie because the truth is going to cost something, and we're not ready to pay.

RAVEN
(beat, standing, not meeting his eyes)
I'll see you at rounds, Dash.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - MORNING
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 6:41 AM

The interns change. Arianna (26), at her locker, glances at the door every few seconds. Marc beside her. Harmony on the bench, lacing her shoes. Esther (26) and Kennerly (27) at the far end.

ARIANNA
(casual, too casual)
Where's Ellison?

MARC
(beat)
Getting coffee.

ARIANNA
(beat)
She said gym.

MARC
(beat)
Coffee after the gym.

Arianna looks at him. He doesn't look back. She closes her locker.

HARMONY
(changing the subject, bright)
Saturday was good. (beat) The move. (beat) Halsey Street.

ESTHER
(from the end of the bench)
Augustin let you in?

HARMONY
(beat)
Jerry and Ronnie carried his bed up four flights. (beat) He watched them like a hawk. (beat) I carried the box with the photo of the hotel, and he took it out of my hands at the top of the stairs and set it on the windowsill himself. (beat) Then he made chicory coffee in a saucepan. (beat) Four cups. (beat) He handed me mine last.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Last is bad.

HARMONY
(beat)
He said, "Merci, Mademoiselle Divine." (beat) Out loud. (beat) In front of my brothers.

ESTHER
(beat, smiling)
Last isn't bad, Kennerly. (beat) Last is "I'm thinking about it."

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - MORNING
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 6:56 AM

Elxa (28), 37 weeks and 2 days pregnant, sits at the station on an exercise ball instead of her stool, rocking gently. The interns gather.

ELXA
(reading off)
Divine: the geriatric overflow on six. Dr. Lowery has a "chest pain" patient who's been here four days with a negative workup, and he wants her gone by noon. (beat) Baker: Cardio, Dr. Robert Bullock's pre-op clinic. (beat) Cummings: Gyn consults with Dr. Hartwell. (beat) Smilley: Neuro, the epilepsy monitoring unit. (beat) Bullock, Kennerly: ER. (beat) Ellison: Cardio, CVICU. (beat) Where is Ellison?

MARC
(beat)
Coffee.

Elxa looks at Marc. Then at Arianna. Then back at Marc.

ELXA
(beat, flat)
Uh-huh.

Raven hurries up, tying back her hair, in scrubs.

RAVEN
(breathless)
Sorry. (beat) Sorry. (beat) The gym.

ELXA
(beat)
You go to a gym now, Ellison?

RAVEN
(beat)
Yes, Dr. Bullock.

ELXA
(beat, back to her clipboard)
Which one?

A long silence. Arianna watches Raven's face.

RAVEN
(beat)
The one on Vernon.

ELXA
(beat, not looking up)
There's no gym on Vernon. (beat) CVICU. Go.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - 6 NORTH - ROOM 611 - MORNING
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 7:16 AM

A private room. MRS. HENRIETTA BOLDEN (88), tiny and fierce in a pink quilted bed jacket, a silver wig set just so, sits up in bed with the Daily News folded to the crossword. A pair of white cotton gloves lies on the tray table. Harmony comes in with the chart.

HARMONY
(warmly)
Good morning, Mrs. Bolden. (beat) I'm Dr. Divine.

HENRIETTA
(not looking up)
Good morning, girl. (beat) I'll take my tea with lemon. (beat) And they forgot my prunes.

HARMONY
(beat)
I'm one of the surgeons, ma'am. (beat) Dr. Divine.

HENRIETTA
(filling in a crossword square)
Mm-hmm. (beat) Lemon. Not that bottled mess.

Harmony takes a breath. She opens the chart.

HARMONY
(reading)
Admitted Monday with chest pain. (beat) EKG normal. Troponins negative times six. Stress test normal. CT angiogram of the chest, normal. Upper endoscopy, normal. (beat) Mrs. Bolden, your heart and your stomach look wonderful. (beat) You're going home today.

Henrietta sets down her pen. She puts a hand flat over her chest.

HENRIETTA
(beat)
Oh. (beat) Oh, there it is again.

HARMONY
(beat)
The pain?

HENRIETTA
(beat, closing her eyes)
Like an elephant, girl. (beat) Right here.

Harmony looks at the bedside monitor. Heart rate seventy-two. Rhythm regular. Pressure one-twenty-eight over seventy-four. Oxygen ninety-nine percent. Perfectly calm.

HARMONY
(beat, carefully)
Mrs. Bolden, your monitor says you're perfectly comfortable.

HENRIETTA
(eyes still closed)
Machines lie, girl. (beat) Ask any colored woman who's ever been weighed at a doctor's office.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIOTHORACIC CLINIC - EXAM ROOM 2 - MORNING
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 7:39 AM

FULTON REESE (61), a retired sanitation supervisor, broad and red-eyed, in a Jets jacket, sits on the exam table. His wife VERNICE REESE (59) sits in the chair with her purse in her lap. Amond reviews the cath films. Robert stands at the counter.

AMOND
(reading)
Three-vessel coronary disease. Left main seventy percent. (beat) An elective CABG, scheduled for Monday.

FULTON
(impatient)
Let's get it done, Doc.

ROBERT
(beat)
Mr. Reese, my notes say you stopped smoking in July.

FULTON
(beat, fast)
July Fourth. (beat) Cold turkey. (beat) Thirty-eight years, two packs a day, and I quit the day of the fireworks.

Amond steps closer to check Fulton's lungs. He leans in with the stethoscope and pauses. He sniffs, very slightly. Then he looks at the man's right hand: the yellowed tips of his index and middle fingers.

AMOND
(beat, evenly)
Breathe in, Mr. Reese.

Fulton breathes. Amond listens. He straightens.

AMOND
(beat, to Robert)
I'd like a urine cotinine level before we finalize Monday. (beat) Standard pre-op.

FULTON
(beat)
What's that?

AMOND
(beat)
A test for nicotine. (beat) Standard.

Vernice, in the chair, looks at her husband and then down at her purse. A beat too long.

VERNICE
(quietly)
Fulton.

FULTON
(sharp)
It's standard, Vernice. (beat)
The man said standard.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 7 - MORNING
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 8:04 AM

SHANICE WARD (15), small, in a puffy coat she refuses to take off, sits doubled over on the gurney, clutching her lower belly. She looks fifteen. Her chart says she's eighteen. Arianna and Clayton stand at the bedside with a nurse. Marc, passing, stops at the curtain.

ARIANNA
(reading)
Shanice Ward. Eighteen. (beat)
Right lower quadrant pain since
last night. (beat) Any chance
you're pregnant?

SHANICE
(too fast)
No.

CLAYTON
(gently)
When was your last period,
Shanice?

SHANICE
(beat)
I don't know. (beat) November.
(beat) It's always messed up.

ARIANNA
(beat)
We need a urine pregnancy test.

SHANICE
(beat)
You don't need my mom's
permission, right? (beat) 'Cause
I'm eighteen.

Arianna and Clayton exchange a glance. The nurse comes back with a cup and a test strip and holds it up: two pink lines.

NURSE
(quietly)
Positive.

Shanice starts to cry. Clayton puts the ultrasound probe on her belly. On the screen: an empty uterus. Off to the right side, a small ring with a flicker in it, outside where it belongs. Free fluid around it.

CLAYTON
(beat, very calm)
Right tubal ectopic. (beat) Seven weeks. (beat) And some blood in the belly.

ARIANNA
(beat, softly)
Shanice. (beat) How old are you really?

Shanice looks at Arianna, at the doctors, at the curtain where Marc stands. She whispers it.

SHANICE
(beat)
Fifteen. (beat) Please don't call my mother.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EPILEPSY MONITORING UNIT - ROOM 3 - MORNING
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 8:28 AM

A dim room with a camera in the ceiling corner. TIFFANY ROYAL (24), a home health aide, sits in bed with EEG electrodes glued all over her scalp, a gauze turban holding the wires in place. Graves (52) and Esther watch a bank of monitors at the nursing station outside: the EEG tracing and a video feed of Tiffany.

GRAVES
(dry)
Ms. Royal. Twenty-four. (beat) Three ER visits in two months for "seizures." (beat) Four antiepileptic drugs. (beat) None of them worked. (beat) She's been with us three days.

ESTHER
(watching the feed)
Any events?

GRAVES
(beat)
Two. (beat) Yesterday. (beat) Both of them occurred when her mother came to visit.

On the video feed, Tiffany suddenly arches. Her arms flail. Her head turns side to side. Her eyes are squeezed tight. Her pelvis thrusts. The nurse runs in.

ESTHER
(urgent, eyes on the EEG)
She's seizing.

GRAVES
(calm, not moving)
Is she, Dr. Smilley? (beat) Look at the brain.

Esther looks at the EEG tracing. Behind the muscle artifact, the brain waves are completely normal. Alpha rhythm, steady as a heartbeat.

ESTHER
(beat, slowly)
No epileptiform activity. (beat) Normal background throughout the event.

GRAVES
(beat)
Eyes squeezed shut. Side-to-side head movement. Pelvic thrusting. Normal EEG. (beat) Psychogenic nonepileptic seizures. (beat) In plain English? (beat) She's faking.

On the screen, the event stops. Tiffany lies still, crying. Esther doesn't take her eyes off her.

ESTHER
(beat, quietly)
PNES isn't faking, Dr. Graves.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - MORNING
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 8:52 AM

Natasha (47) at her desk with Malcolm Sloan's credentialing file. Bernie (55) brings in the mail and sets a stack on the corner of the desk. Robert (49) comes in with two coffees, sets one in front of Natasha and picks up his own mail from the stack: a few journals and a long cream envelope forwarded from the Howard University alumni office, with a Chicago law-firm return address. "WHITAKER, STEIN & ADEBAYO, LLP."

Robert looks at the envelope. Something passes over his face, very fast. He slides it into the inside pocket of his white coat.

NATASHA
(not looking up)
Malcolm Sloan starts on the thirteenth. (beat) February. (beat) Sylvia wants him to present at the Department meeting his first week.

ROBERT
(beat)
In front of Clayton.

NATASHA
(beat)
In front of everybody. (beat) What's that?

ROBERT
(beat)
What?

NATASHA
(beat)
The envelope. (beat) You put it in your pocket like a pack of cigarettes.

A pause, a fraction of a second too long.

ROBERT
(beat, easily)
Alumni fund. (beat) They want a pledge for the new medical library. (beat) They track you to the end of the earth.

NATASHA
(beat, going back to the file)
Give them something. (beat) You always say Howard made you.

ROBERT
(beat)
I always say that.

He picks up his coffee and leaves. Natasha keeps reading. She doesn't see his hand rest briefly over his coat pocket in the hallway.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 7 - MORNING
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 9:19 AM

Shanice, pale, an IV in her arm, lies on the gurney. Arianna holds her hand. The curtain is yanked back. A heavyset woman in a home attendant's uniform, out of breath: SHANICE'S MOTHER, RENEE WARD (38). Behind her, the

registration clerk.

RENEE
(frantic)
Shanice! (beat) The school called. They said you got sick on the bus. (beat) What happened? (beat) Why are you in the emergency room? (beat) Why is your name on the board under "eighteen"?

Shanice turns her face to the wall. Arianna stands up.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Mrs. Ward. (beat) I'm Dr. Cummings.

RENEE
(to Arianna)
What's wrong with my baby?

Before Arianna can answer, Shanice gasps. Her whole body tenses. Her hand goes to her shoulder. The monitor alarms: heart rate one forty, pressure eighty over forty.

SHANICE
(whimpering)
My shoulder. (beat) Why does my shoulder hurt?

ARIANNA
(instantly, to the nurse)
Kehr's sign. (beat) She's ruptured. (beat) Page Dr. Hartwell. OR. Now. (beat) Type and cross two units.

RENEE
(screaming)
Ruptured what? (beat) Ruptured what?

Arianna looks at the mother. Then at the girl, who has turned away from both of them. There's no time to lie and no time to soften it.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Mrs. Ward. (beat) Your daughter is pregnant. (beat) In her fallopian tube. (beat) It just burst. (beat) She's bleeding inside, and we're taking her to surgery right now.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 7 - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 9:41 AM

Laparoscopy. On the monitor: a pelvis full of dark blood, a right fallopian tube swollen and torn, still oozing. Clayton (34) works the instruments. Arianna holds the camera and suction.

CLAYTON
(calm)
Suction the pelvis. (beat) There. (beat) Ruptured right tubal ectopic. (beat) Five hundred cc's of hemoperitoneum.

ARIANNA
(suctioning)
Salpingectomy?

CLAYTON
(beat)
The tube's destroyed. (beat) Yes. (beat) We take it. (beat) Her left tube looks perfect. (beat) She can still have children when she's ready.

Clayton fires the bipolar along the tube's mesentery and divides it. The tube comes free. He bags it.

CLAYTON
(beat, eyes on the screen)
You told her mother the truth in the ER. (beat) All of it. Fast.

ARIANNA
(beat)
There wasn't time to do it any other way.

CLAYTON
(beat)
There's always time to lie, Dr. Cummings. (beat) Most people find it.

ARIANNA
(beat, flat)
My father lied about where he was going for twenty years. (beat) Every night. (beat) "The VFW." (beat) It was always the corner of Penn and Highland, with a needle. (beat) I don't find it.

Clayton glances at her over his mask. He doesn't say anything. He hands her the trocar.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Close the ports.

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - 6 NORTH - ROOM 611 - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 10:12 AM

Henrietta Bolden finishes the crossword in ink. Harmony comes in with the discharge papers and a cup of tea with a fresh lemon wedge balanced on the saucer. She sets it down.

HENRIETTA
(beat, examining the lemon)
Real lemon. (beat) Well, look at that.

HARMONY
(beat)
Mrs. Bolden. (beat) Your discharge paperwork is ready. (beat) Your granddaughter's number is on the face sheet. I'll call her to pick you up.

HENRIETTA
(beat, sipping)
She lives in Charlotte, girl.

Harmony pauses.

HARMONY
(beat)
Then who's at home?

HENRIETTA
(beat)
Me.

She sets the teacup down. Her hand goes to her chest. Her face crumples in exaggerated pain.

HENRIETTA
(beat, a little too loudly)
Oh. (beat) Oh, Lord, there it is.

Harmony looks at the monitor: heart rate seventy, perfectly steady. She looks back at Henrietta, who opens one eye to check whether it worked.

HARMONY
(beat, gently)
Mrs. Bolden. (beat) Your heart rate didn't change.

HENRIETTA
(beat, sitting up straight, the pain gone)
You're a smart one, girl.

HARMONY
(beat)
Doctor.

HENRIETTA
(beat, picking up her pen)
You bring the tea, you check the monitor, you fluff the pillow. (beat) You're the girl. (beat) I know what a girl is. (beat) I was one on Park Avenue for forty-one years.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIOTHORACIC CLINIC - EXAM ROOM 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 10:34 AM

Fulton and Vernice Reese. Amond holds a lab printout. Robert stands with his arms folded.

AMOND
(beat)
Urine cotinine, twelve hundred nanograms per milliliter, Mr. Reese. (beat) A non-smoker is under ten. (beat) A pack-a-day smoker is in the hundreds. (beat) This is two packs a day.

FULTON
(beat, instantly)
Secondhand. (beat) The guys at the VFW. (beat) Bingo night. (beat) It's a smoky room.

AMOND
(beat)
You can't get to twelve hundred from bingo night.

FULTON
(getting red in the face)
Are you calling me a liar, son?

AMOND
(beat, evenly)
I'm calling your urine a reliable witness, Mr. Reese.

Vernice makes a small sound, half a laugh and half a sob, and covers her mouth.

ROBERT
(beat, calm)
Mr. Reese. (beat) Smoking right up to bypass surgery means a higher risk of pneumonia, wound infections, graft failure and death. (beat) Your left main is seventy percent. (beat) You're not stable enough to wait forever, and you're not safe enough to cut on Monday. (beat) I'm postponing the surgery four weeks. (beat) Nicotine patch, bupropion, a cessation counselor. (beat) Then we talk again.

FULTON
(standing, furious)
Four weeks? (beat) My heart could quit in four weeks!

ROBERT
(beat)
Then help us keep it going, Mr. Reese. (beat) Stop lying to the people trying to save you.

Fulton grabs his jacket and storms out. Vernice stays in her chair. She looks up at Amond.

VERNICE
(beat, very quietly)
He smokes in the garage. (beat) Every night at eleven. (beat) He thinks I don't know. (beat) I've known for thirty-eight years.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 11:02 AM

Raven and Arianna at a corner table with sandwiches. Miss Hattie (60) watches from behind the register. Arianna

doesn't eat.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Where were you this morning?

RAVEN
(beat)
I told you. The gym.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You don't have a gym.

RAVEN
(beat)
I joined one.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Which one?

RAVEN
(beat, fumbling)
The Bally's. On... (beat) In Long Island City.

ARIANNA
(beat, very flat)
There's no Bally's in Long Island City, Raven. (beat) Elxa asked you the same question three hours ago. (beat) You said Vernon. (beat) Now it's Bally's. (beat) You're getting worse at this.

Raven puts down her sandwich.

RAVEN
(beat)
Arianna...

ARIANNA
(beat)
I don't want you to explain.
(beat) I want you to stop lying.
(beat) Those are different.

Arianna stands, picks up her tray and walks away. Miss Hattie, at the register, pretends to count change.

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EPILEPSY MONITORING UNIT - ROOM 3 - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 11:27 AM

Tiffany Royal sits in bed, exhausted, still wired to the EEG. Esther sits in the chair beside her. Graves stands at the door with his arms folded, skeptical.

TIFFANY
(beat)
He thinks I'm faking. (beat) I heard him through the door.

ESTHER
(beat)
Dr. Graves thinks your seizures aren't epilepsy. (beat) That's true. (beat) Your brain waves were normal during the event this morning. (beat) Completely normal.

TIFFANY
(crying)
So I'm crazy.

ESTHER
(beat)
No. (beat) They're called psychogenic nonepileptic seizures. (beat) They're real. (beat) You're not choosing to have them. (beat) They're your body's way of dealing with something your mind can't hold anymore. (beat) They're as real as a broken arm. (beat) They just aren't treated with the same medicine.

At the door, Graves shifts his weight.

TIFFANY
(beat)
Then what's wrong with me?

ESTHER
(beat, carefully)
Both of your events yesterday happened while your mother was in the room. (beat) And this morning's happened when the nurse said your mother called.

Tiffany goes very still. A long silence. She pulls the blanket up to her chin.

TIFFANY
(whispering)
I take care of old people. (beat) For a living. (beat) I bathe them. (beat) I lift them. (beat) Nobody lifted me.

ESTHER
(beat, very gently)
Who should have, Tiffany?

Tiffany doesn't answer. She turns her face toward the wall. Graves, at the door, lowers his arms.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 4 - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 11:51 AM

An elderly man lies on the gurney, gray and breathing with difficulty. His adult son and daughter stand at the bedside. Kennerly, in Gloria's tie under his white coat, stands with an X-ray in his hand. Marc is beside him. Gloria at the monitor.

SON
(anxious)
Is it pneumonia? (beat) They said at the nursing home it was probably just pneumonia.

KENNERLY
(beat, without hesitating)
It's a mass. (beat) Six centimeters, in the right lung, with fluid around it. (beat) It's almost certainly cancer. (beat) The fluid is why he can't breathe. (beat) We can drain it today, and he'll feel better. (beat) The cancer is probably not something we can cure.

The daughter sits down hard in the chair. The son stares at Kennerly.

SON
(beat)
You just... (beat) Nobody's ever just said it like that.

KENNERLY
(beat)
I could have said "a shadow." (beat) Or "we need more tests." (beat) You'd have spent a week hoping. (beat) He doesn't have a week to waste on your hope, sir. (beat) I'm sorry.

Marc watches him. Gloria, at the monitor, glances at Kennerly and then away.

GLORIA
(quietly, to Marc, as Kennerly sets up the thoracentesis tray)
He's still too blunt. (beat) But he doesn't lie. (beat) Half the attendings in this building can't say that.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - NURSES' STATION - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 12:14 PM

Arianna drops off a consult note on a post-op gyn patient transferred to CVICU. The charge nurse, YVETTE BANKS (42), signs for it. Arianna turns to go.

YVETTE
(friendly, chatting)
Your girlfriend's sweet with Bed 5. (beat) Dr. Ellison.

Arianna stops.

YVETTE
(beat, not noticing)
Six a.m. every day this week, before her shift. (beat) Brings him decaf. (beat) Sits with him till ten to seven. (beat) His mama calls her "the angel."

Arianna stands very still. Through the glass of Bed 5, she can see Dash asleep, a paper coffee cup on his tray table.

ARIANNA
(beat, perfectly calm)
Every day this week.

YVETTE
(beat, finally looking up, seeing her face)
Oh. (beat) Oh, honey. (beat) I thought you knew.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I do now.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 12:38 PM

Natasha at her desk. Robert comes in, takes off his white coat and drapes it over the back of the sofa. The corner of the cream envelope shows at the edge of the inside pocket. Natasha notices it.

NATASHA
(beat)
Did you pledge?

ROBERT
(beat)
What?

NATASHA
(beat)
The Howard library. (beat) The alumni fund.

ROBERT
(beat)
Oh. (beat) Not yet. (beat) I'll do it this weekend.

Natasha looks at the envelope in his coat. Then at him. She has been married to this man for twenty-seven years, and she knows the face he makes when an operation has gone wrong and he hasn't decided to tell her yet.

NATASHA
(beat, lightly)
Five thousand. (beat) Pledge five thousand. (beat) Put my name on it too.

ROBERT
(beat)
Five thousand.

He picks up a journal from her desk and pretends to read it. Natasha turns back to her own file. Neither of them reads a word.

19 INT. ROBERT'S CAR - QUEENS GRACE PARKING GARAGE - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 1:02 PM

A silver Mercedes sedan, parked on Level 2, engine off. Robert sits alone behind the wheel. He takes out the cream envelope and slits it open with a car key. Inside: a single sheet of letterhead and a second, smaller envelope, sealed, yellowed, addressed in an elegant woman's hand: "Robert Bullock -- Personal."

He reads the letterhead letter.

> "Dear Dr. Bullock: We represent the Estate of Delphine A. Ware, M.D., who passed away in Chicago in March 2003. Among Dr. Ware's papers was the enclosed sealed letter, with written instructions that it be delivered to you personally 'once the estate is settled.' The estate was settled on December 30, 2005. We have not read its contents. Sincerely, R. Adebayo."

Robert stares at the sealed envelope. "Robert Bullock -- Personal." He knows the handwriting. Twenty-four years, and he knows the handwriting.

ROBERT
(barely, to himself)
Delphine.

He turns the small envelope over in his hands. He doesn't open it. He opens the glove compartment, sets it inside on top of the owner's manual, and closes it with a click. Then he sits in the dark garage with both hands on the steering wheel for a very long time.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - GYNECOLOGY RECOVERY - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 1:27 PM

Shanice, post-op, groggy, an IV in her arm. Renee sits in the chair, still in her home attendant's uniform, with her arms crossed tight. Neither of them is talking. Arianna checks the incisions.

RENEE
(finally, to the ceiling)
You told them you were eighteen.

SHANICE
(beat, barely)
I didn't want them to call you.

RENEE
(beat)
Why?

SHANICE
(crying)
Because you work two jobs, Ma. (beat) Because you already think I'm stupid. (beat) Because you'd have looked at me like you're looking at me right now.

Renee uncrosses her arms. She doesn't know what to do with her hands.

ARIANNA
(beat, quietly, still checking the dressing)
Mrs. Ward. (beat) When I was fifteen, I told the man at the Eat'n Park on McKnight Road I was seventeen so he'd give me a job. (beat) I needed the money because my father had spent the rent. (beat) I lied because the truth would have put me in a foster home. (beat) Shanice didn't lie because she's stupid. (beat) She lied because she was scared of being alone with this.

Renee looks at Arianna. Then at her daughter.

RENEE
(beat, her voice breaking)
Baby. (beat) You're not alone. (beat) I'm your mother. (beat) You could have told me anything.

SHANICE
(beat, sobbing)
I'm telling you now.

Renee gets up, sits on the edge of the bed and gathers her daughter into her arms, IV and all. Arianna steps out of the curtain and stands in the hallway, her jaw tight.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - 6 NORTH - ROOM 611 - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 1:54 PM

Henrietta Bolden sits in the chair by the window now, dressed in a navy church suit, her white gloves on, her pocketbook on her lap, as if she's ready to leave. She isn't leaving. Harmony sits on the edge of the bed across from her. CELIA MONTAGUE, LCSW (39), the hospital social worker, stands by the door with a folder.

CELIA
(gently)
Mrs. Bolden. (beat) Dr. Divine called me. (beat) Your landlord on West 141st Street filed an eviction notice in December. (beat) The building's being converted to condominiums. (beat) Your marshal's date is next Thursday.

Henrietta stares out the window at the gray river.

HARMONY
(beat, softly)
That's why you have chest pain, isn't it, Mrs. Bolden?

HENRIETTA
(beat, finally)
Fifty-two years, girl. (beat) In that apartment. (beat) I raised three children in it. (beat) Buried my husband out of it. (beat) Took the A train to Park Avenue every morning at six for forty-one years to raise other people's children. (beat) And now a man from Connecticut who's never seen the inside of it says I have to go. (beat) Where? (beat) My granddaughter has a two-bedroom in Charlotte with three children in it. (beat) There's no room. (beat) There's never been room.

She opens her pocketbook and takes out a folded, worn eviction notice. Her hands are shaking in the white gloves.

HENRIETTA
(beat)
In here, they bring me tea. (beat) In here, somebody comes when I ring. (beat) So I rang.

Harmony takes the notice from her. She reads it. She looks up at Celia.

HARMONY
(beat)
Ms. Montague. (beat) What do we have?

CELIA
(beat, opening the folder)
Not much by Thursday. (beat) But I've got a friend at the Abyssinian Development Corporation. (beat) And Mrs. Bolden is eighty-eight years old and a lifelong member of the congregation.

Henrietta looks at Harmony. Not at the white coat. At her.

HENRIETTA
(beat, very quietly)
Why do you care, girl?

HARMONY
(beat)
Because my father drove a city bus for thirty-one years, Mrs. Bolden, and my mother serves lunch in a school cafeteria. (beat) And somebody called them "boy" and "girl" for all of it.

22 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 2:16 PM

The bar in the dead of the afternoon. Monty (43) reads the Post. Marc and Amond eat at the bar.

MARC
(beat)
I lied for Raven. (beat) Twice. (beat) Today. (beat) To Arianna. (beat) "Coffee." "The gym."

AMOND
(beat, chewing)
I know. (beat) I was there for "gym."

MARC
(beat)
She's my best friend, Amond. (beat) She asked me not to say anything. (beat) She's... (beat) She's in love with a dying man, and she doesn't know what to do.

AMOND
(beat)
So you lied to the woman who's in love with her.

Marc doesn't answer.

AMOND
(beat, setting down his burger)
My father's car was T-boned on Stocker Street when I was nine. (beat) I watched him bleed out. (beat) For six months afterward my mother told everyone at church he had a "heart attack." (beat) She said it was easier. (beat) I stood next to her every Sunday and said, "Yes, a heart attack." (beat) I was nine. (beat) I believed that lying for someone was a way of loving them.

MARC
(beat)
It isn't?

AMOND
(beat)
It's a way of making them need you. (beat) Stop lying for people, Marc. (beat) It's not your truth to hold.

MONTY
(not looking up from the Post)
He's right. (beat) I'm a vault, but I'm a vault, Marc. (beat) I never stood in front of anybody and said "the gym."

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 2:43 PM

Dash, awake. Glenda has gone back to her hotel to sleep. Raven sits beside him checking his drips, her face wrecked.

DASH
(beat)
You lied to her.

RAVEN
(beat)
Yes.

DASH
(beat)
For me.

RAVEN
(beat)
For me, Dash. (beat) So I wouldn't have to say it.

DASH
(beat, quietly)
Say what?

Raven doesn't answer. Dash reaches for her hand. She lets him take it.

DASH
(beat)
Raven. (beat) Listen to me. (beat) I'm on day seventy. (beat) My heart's a cantaloupe with a short in the wiring. (beat) I don't have time for anybody to lie about me. (beat) Not you. Not the night nurses. Not my mama. (beat) If I go, I want to go with everybody in this room knowing exactly what was true.

RAVEN
(beat, crying)
You're not going anywhere.

DASH
(beat)
See? (beat) There you go again.

She laughs through her tears and holds on to his hand with both of hers. Behind her, unseen, the glass door of the CVICU slides open. Arianna stands in the doorway with a chart in her hand, looking at Raven holding Dash's hand.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - CORRIDOR - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 2:47 PM

The corridor outside the glass. Raven comes out of Bed 5, wiping her eyes, and stops dead. Arianna stands against the far wall with the chart pressed to her chest.

RAVEN
(beat)
Arianna.

ARIANNA
(very calm)
Six a.m. (beat) Every day this week. (beat) Decaf. (beat) His mother calls you "the angel." (beat) The charge nurse told me. (beat) She thought I knew.

RAVEN
(beat)
I was going to tell you.

ARIANNA
(beat)
When? (beat) After the gym? (beat) After Bally's?

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
I didn't know how.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You say, "Arianna, I go see a patient every morning before work because I'm falling in love with him." (beat) Fourteen words. (beat) I counted them on the way up here.

Raven can't speak.

ARIANNA
(beat, her voice finally cracking)
Bullock lied for you. (beat) Twice. (beat) Elxa caught you. (beat) Miss Hattie knew. (beat) The charge nurse knew. (beat) The man in the bed knew. (beat) Everybody in this hospital was protecting you, Raven. (beat) Nobody was protecting me.

RAVEN
(beat, stepping toward her)
I love you.

ARIANNA
(beat, stepping back)
I know you do. (beat) That's the worst part. (beat) I know you do.

She walks away down the corridor. Raven stands alone outside the glass. Inside, Dash, awake now, has seen everything. He closes his eyes.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIOTHORACIC CLINIC - EXAM ROOM 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 3:14 PM

Fulton Reese is back, alone, sitting on the exam table in his Jets jacket. His eyes are red. Amond comes in with the chart. Fulton holds up a hand before Amond can speak.

FULTON
(beat, gruff)
Vernice says she's known for thirty-eight years. (beat) The garage. (beat) Eleven o'clock. (beat) She's been putting a cup of coffee on the workbench for me every night since 1968. (beat) She never said a word.

AMOND
(beat)
She said one today.

FULTON
(beat)
Two packs. (beat) Every day. (beat) I quit four times. (beat) I quit on July Fourth for nine hours. (beat) I can't do it, Doc. (beat) That's the truth. (beat) I can't.

Amond sits on the stool across from him. He doesn't open the chart.

AMOND
(beat)
Mr. Reese. (beat) You don't have to do it alone. (beat) The patch. Bupropion. A counselor every week. (beat) Your wife and her coffee. (beat) Four weeks. (beat) And if you slip, you call me, and you tell me. (beat) That's all I need. (beat) Not that you never slip. (beat) That you never lie about it.

FULTON
(beat)
Why does that matter to you, son?

AMOND
(beat)
Because I can operate on a man who smokes, Mr. Reese. (beat) I can't operate on a man who lies to me. (beat) I don't know what I'm cutting into.

Fulton looks at him for a long moment. Then he takes a crumpled pack of Newports from his jacket and sets it on the exam table between them.

FULTON
(beat)
That's my last one. (beat) The pack. (beat) Not the cigarette. (beat) I'm not going to lie to you, Doc.

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EPILEPSY MONITORING UNIT - ROOM 3 - DAY

FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 3:38 PM

Tiffany, the EEG electrodes now removed, her hair matted, sits in bed. Esther sits beside her. A psychiatrist's consult card is on the tray table: "DR. HAROLD BYNUM, CONSULT-LIAISON PSYCHIATRY." Graves stands in the doorway.

TIFFANY
(beat, barely)
My stepfather. (beat) From when I was nine until I was fourteen. (beat) My mother knew. (beat) She told me I was lying. (beat) She told the pastor I was lying. (beat) And now she visits me in the hospital every day like she's the one who's sick.

Esther holds very still.

ESTHER
(beat)
Tiffany. (beat) Thank you for telling me the truth.

TIFFANY
(crying)
Nobody ever said that to me before.

ESTHER
(beat)
Then I'll say it again. (beat) Thank you for telling me the truth. (beat) Dr. Bynum is going to come see you this afternoon. (beat) He's very kind. (beat) We're going to stop the seizure medicines you don't need. (beat) And we're going to ask the nurses to call you before your mother comes up, so you can decide if you want to see her.

In the doorway, Graves steps forward.

GRAVES
(beat, quietly)
Ms. Royal. (beat) I said a word this morning. (beat) "Faking." (beat) I was wrong. (beat) I apologize.

Tiffany stares at the white-haired Chief of Neurosurgery. She nods. Graves looks at Esther.

GRAVES
(beat, in the hall, low)
Thirty years, and I learned something from an intern today. (beat) Don't tell anyone, Dr. Smilley.

ESTHER
(beat)
I won't lie for you, Dr. Graves. (beat) But I won't volunteer it either.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 4:02 PM

Elxa on the exercise ball, rocking, sweating slightly. Natasha comes up the hall with a folder and stops.

NATASHA
(beat)
How are you?

ELXA
(beat, too fast)
Fine.

NATASHA
(beat)
Elxa.

ELXA
(beat)
I'm fine, Mama.

Natasha sets the folder down. She just waits, the way she's waited Elxa out since Elxa was two.

ELXA
(beat, giving in)
My back's been hurting since noon. (beat) Low. (beat) It comes and goes. (beat) Every fifteen, maybe twenty minutes. (beat) It's Braxton Hicks. (beat) It's nothing.

NATASHA
(beat, very calm)
It might be nothing. (beat) At thirty-seven weeks and two days, it might also be early labor. (beat) Call Dr. Hampton. (beat) Call your husband. (beat) Go home and lie down. (beat) Today.

ELXA
(beat)
I've got the board until seven.

NATASHA
(beat)
Then I'll take the board until seven.

ELXA
(beat, staring)
You're the Chief of Surgery.

NATASHA
(beat, sitting down on the stool, taking the clipboard)
I ran this board in 1990 for six months when we couldn't afford a chief resident. (beat) Go home, baby. (beat) Don't lie to me about your back.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - 6 NORTH - ROOM 611 - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 4:29 PM

Henrietta, in her church suit and gloves, sits in the chair. Celia Montague comes in with Harmony, holding a printed letter.

CELIA
(smiling)
Mrs. Bolden. (beat) Abyssinian Development has a one-bedroom in a senior building on West 138th Street. (beat) Elevator. Handrails. A super who lives on site. (beat) Three hundred and twelve dollars a month. (beat) Available February first. (beat) And Legal Aid has agreed to file for a stay on your eviction until then.

Henrietta reads the letter. She reads it again. She takes off her reading glasses.

HENRIETTA
(beat, barely)
An elevator.

CELIA
(beat)
An elevator.

HENRIETTA
(beat)
I've climbed four flights at 141st Street since 1954. (beat) My knees haven't seen an elevator since Park Avenue. (beat) And that was the service elevator.

She folds the letter carefully and puts it in her pocketbook. Then she looks up at Harmony.

HENRIETTA
(beat)
You called them. (beat) You found this.

HARMONY
(beat)
Ms. Montague found it, ma'am.

CELIA
(beat)
Dr. Divine called me at ten-fifteen this morning and didn't hang up until I had a plan.

Henrietta studies Harmony for a long moment.

HENRIETTA
(beat)
I'll be discharged now.

HARMONY
(beat)
Yes, ma'am.

HENRIETTA
(beat, rising slowly, gathering her pocketbook)
Then I'll need someone to sign my papers. (beat) Not the girl. (beat) The doctor.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 4 - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 4:41 PM

The elderly man from this morning sits up now, breathing easier, a chest tube bag beside the gurney holding two liters of straw-colored fluid. His son and daughter sit with him. Kennerly checks the tube. The daughter catches his sleeve.

DAUGHTER
(beat)
Dr. Kennerly. (beat) He talked to us. (beat) For an hour. (beat) First time since Thanksgiving. (beat) He asked for his grandson.

KENNERLY
(beat)
The fluid was pressing on his lung. (beat) He can breathe now. (beat) It won't last forever.

DAUGHTER
(beat)
I know. (beat) You told us. (beat) That's why we called his grandson. (beat) He's flying in from Fort Bragg tonight.

Kennerly looks at her. Then at the old man, who lifts a weak hand in salute.

SON
(beat, gruff)
Thank you for not giving us a shadow, Doc.

Kennerly nods once and walks out. In the hallway, he stops and loosens Gloria's tie, as if it suddenly got tight.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL B - DAY
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 4:53 PM

Arianna sits alone on the landing between four and five. The door opens. Marc comes down the stairs and stops. She

doesn't look up.

ARIANNA
(flat)
"Coffee."

MARC
(beat)
I'm sorry.

ARIANNA
(beat)
"Coffee after the gym."

MARC
(beat, sitting down two steps above her)
I'm sorry, Arianna. (beat) She asked me not to say anything. (beat) I thought that's what a friend does.

ARIANNA
(beat)
A friend to who?

Marc doesn't answer.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You've known me since July first, Bullock. (beat) We stood next to each other at orientation. (beat) You were the first person in this building who called me "Problem" like it was a compliment. (beat) And when it came down to it, you lied to my face for her.

MARC
(beat)
I know.

ARIANNA
(beat, looking up at him finally)
Everybody lies to protect Raven. (beat) Because Raven's sweet. (beat) Raven's the angel. (beat) Raven had the hard childhood. (beat) I had a hard childhood too. (beat) Nobody ever lied to protect me.

MARC
(beat, quietly)
Then let me stop. (beat) Right now. (beat) Here's the truth. (beat) She loves you. (beat) She's falling in love with him. (beat) She doesn't know what to do. (beat) And she's terrified that if she chooses either one of you, he dies. (beat) That's all of it. (beat) No more coffee.

Arianna looks at him for a long time.

ARIANNA
(beat, barely)
Thank you.

31 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 7:12 PM

The kitchen. Raven sits at the table in her coat, still. The front door opens. Arianna comes in with a canvas tote bag. She goes upstairs without speaking. A minute later she comes back down. The tote bag is full: a toothbrush, a Pitt sweatshirt, two review books, a phone charger and a box of purple Sharpies.

Raven stands up.

RAVEN
(barely)
What are you doing?

ARIANNA
(beat)
Taking my things.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

32 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 7:14 PM

Mercy sits between them on the kitchen floor, looking from one woman to the other.

RAVEN
(beat)
Arianna. (beat) Please.

ARIANNA
(beat, steady)
I'm not breaking up with you. (beat) I'm not breaking anything. (beat) I'm taking a step back. (beat) So you can see what's in front of you without me standing in the way.

RAVEN
(beat)
You're not in the way.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Raven. (beat) I spent my whole childhood being the thing somebody had to lie about. (beat) "She's fine." "Her father's at the VFW." "Her mother's resting." (beat) I'm not going to be your gym. (beat) I'm not going to be your second chair. (beat) Figure out what you want. (beat) Tell me the truth when you do. (beat) Fourteen words. (beat) I'll be in Astoria.

She shoulders the bag. She crouches, scratches Mercy behind her lopsided ear and stands up.

ARIANNA
(beat, at the door, not turning)
He's a good man, Raven. (beat) I'm not stupid. (beat) I can see why. (beat) That's what makes it so hard to hate him.

The front door closes. Raven sits back down at the kitchen table. Mercy puts her head on Raven's knee.

33 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - MAIN LOBBY - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 7:31 PM

Henrietta Bolden, in her church suit, gloves, pocketbook and a wool coat, sits in a wheelchair by the revolving door. A livery cab idles at the curb outside. Harmony, off shift, in her coat, kneels to tuck a blanket over her knees.

HENRIETTA
(beat)
West 138th Street on the first of February. (beat) An elevator. (beat) I'm going to ride it up and down ten times just because I can.

HARMONY
(beat, smiling)
Do it twenty.

Henrietta reaches out with one gloved hand and touches Harmony's cheek.

HENRIETTA
(beat)
Forty-one years, the lady on Park Avenue called me "Henrietta" and her children called me "Hetty." (beat) Not one of them ever called me Mrs. Bolden. (beat) Not once. (beat) Not even at her funeral, where I sat in the back. (beat) And I came in here and did the same thing to you. (beat) Called you "girl" because it's what I was called. (beat) Like it was the only thing a colored woman in a uniform could be.

HARMONY
(beat, barely)
Mrs. Bolden...

HENRIETTA
(beat, firmly)
Thank you, Dr. Divine.

Harmony stops breathing for a second. The cabbie honks. Henrietta waves him quiet with one glove.

HENRIETTA
(beat)
Don't you let anybody call you anything else.

34 INT. ARIANNA'S APARTMENT - ABOVE THE BAKERY - ASTORIA - NIGHT

FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 7:52 PM

Arianna sets the canvas tote bag down on the floor of her small room. She unpacks it slowly: the toothbrush, the Pitt sweatshirt, the review books. The box of purple Sharpies she holds for a long time. Her phone buzzes. An unfamiliar number. She answers.

ARIANNA
(flat)
Cummings.

RENEE (V.O.)
(on the phone, hesitant)
Dr. Cummings? (beat) It's Renee Ward. (beat) Shanice's mother. (beat) The nurse gave me your pager, and the operator gave me this. (beat) I'm sorry. I know it's late.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Is Shanice okay?

RENEE (V.O.)
(beat)
She's sleeping. (beat) She's okay. (beat) I just wanted to say... (beat) The thing you said. (beat) About the Eat'n Park. (beat) Being scared to be alone with it. (beat) I didn't know. (beat) I didn't know my own child was scared of me. (beat) Thank you for telling me the truth, even when it wasn't yours to tell.

Arianna sits down slowly on the bed.

ARIANNA
(beat, barely)
You're welcome, Mrs. Ward.

She hangs up. She sets the purple Sharpies on the windowsill where she can see them.

35 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 8:04 PM

Robert at the kitchen island, writing a check. Natasha comes in, still in her coat, home from running the surgical board for three hours. She sets her bag down and looks over his shoulder. The check: "HOWARD UNIVERSITY -- LOUIS STOKES HEALTH SCIENCES LIBRARY -- $5,000.00."

NATASHA
(beat)
You pledged.

ROBERT
(beat)
You told me to.

Natasha looks at the check. Then at him.

NATASHA
(beat, lightly)
The envelope was from Chicago, Robert. (beat) I saw the postmark. (beat) The alumni office is in Washington.

Robert's pen stops.

ROBERT
(beat)
Forwarded. (beat) Chicago chapter. (beat) Howard alumni of Chicago. (beat) They're very active.

NATASHA
(beat)
Are they.

ROBERT
(beat, not looking up)
Very.

A long silence. Natasha takes off her coat and hangs it on the hook by the door.

NATASHA
(beat, very calmly)
I've been sober for fifteen years, Robert. (beat) Do you know what the first thing they teach you is? (beat) It's not about the drink. (beat) It's that secrets keep you sick. (beat) Whatever's in that envelope, it'll keep. (beat) But it won't keep forever.

She walks out of the kitchen. Robert sits alone with the check and the pen in his hand.

36 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 8:42 PM

Clayton reads on the sofa. Esther comes in, hangs up her coat and sits down beside him, closer than usual.

ESTHER
(beat)
No more Octobers.

CLAYTON
(beat, looking up)
Okay.

ESTHER
(beat)
Nine days ago. (beat) The vow renewal. (beat) In the ICU. (beat) Marc took my hand during the hymn. (beat) I let him hold it. (beat) For about a minute. (beat) Then I let go.

Clayton closes his book. He takes a long breath.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Why are you telling me?

ESTHER
(beat)
Because if I don't, it becomes an October. (beat) And because I spent the whole day watching people lie to each other in this hospital, and every single lie made something worse. (beat) I'm not going to be one of them.

CLAYTON
(beat, quietly)
Thank you for telling me.

ESTHER
(beat)
It doesn't make you angry?

CLAYTON
(beat)
It makes me terrified. (beat) But I'd rather be terrified with the truth than comfortable with a lie. (beat) I was comfortable with a lie for a year in Boston. (beat) Look where it got us.

37 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 9:18 PM

Dash, awake in the blue light. Raven comes in, in her street clothes, red-eyed. She sits in the chair and doesn't say anything for a long moment.

DASH
(beat)
She left.

RAVEN
(beat)
She took a step back. (beat) Her words.

DASH
(beat)
Because of me.

RAVEN
(beat)
Because of me.

Dash looks at the ceiling.

DASH
(beat)
I'm sorry, Raven. (beat) I mean that. (beat) I'm not going to lie to you and say I'm only sorry. (beat) Part of me is glad. (beat) And I hate that part of me. (beat) But you said no lies today.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
No lies.

DASH
(beat)
Then tell me one true thing. (beat) Just one. (beat) And then go home and sleep.

Raven looks at him. At the drips, the pads on his chest, the calendar that says "DAY 70."

RAVEN
(beat, whispering)
I don't want to come here at six in the morning because you're my patient. (beat) I come because I can't stand to start a day without seeing you.

Dash closes his eyes. A tear runs down into his ear.

DASH
(beat)
That's a good one. (beat) Go home, Raven.

38 INT. THE DIVINE HOUSE - CAMBRIA HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 9:46 PM

Lillian sits in her armchair with her reading glasses on and a copy of "A Million Little Pieces" in her lap. The TV shows a news segment about the memoir controversy. Howard dozes on the sofa. Lillian closes the book, stands, walks into the kitchen and drops it into the trash can. She comes back, picks up her Bible from the side table and sits down again.

HOWARD
(eyes closed, amused)
You finished it?

LILLIAN
(beat, opening the Bible)
I finished with it. (beat) That's different. (beat) If a man's going to lie to me for four hundred pages, he could at least have had the decency to call it a novel.

39 INT. THE REESE HOUSE - GARAGE - SPRINGFIELD GARDENS - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 11:00 PM

A cluttered one-car garage: tools, a workbench, a space heater, a folding chair. Fulton Reese sits in the folding chair in his Jets jacket, a nicotine patch on his upper arm, his hands shaking slightly. No cigarette. The door to the house opens. Vernice comes out in her robe and slippers, carrying a mug of coffee. She sets it on the workbench, where she has set a mug every night since 1968. Then, for the first time in thirty-eight years, she pulls over an overturned paint bucket and sits down beside him.

FULTON
(beat, staring at his hands)
It's eleven o'clock.

VERNICE
(beat)
I know what time it is, Fulton.

FULTON
(beat)
I want one so bad I could cry.

VERNICE
(beat, picking up his shaking hand and holding it)
Then cry. (beat) I'll sit here. (beat) I've been sitting on the other side of that door for thirty-eight years. (beat) I'd rather sit on this side.

TAG

40 INT. ROBERT'S CAR - QUEENS GRACE PARKING GARAGE - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 11:36 PM

Robert sits behind the wheel of the parked Mercedes, alone, coat on, keys in hand. He hasn't started the engine. He opens the glove compartment. The small yellowed envelope sits on the owner's manual: "Robert Bullock -- Personal." He looks at it for a long moment. He reaches for it. Then he closes the glove compartment again and starts the car.

MARC (V.O.)
Patients lie to doctors. Doctors lie right back.

41 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
FRIDAY, JANUARY 20, 2006 - 11:58 PM

Marc sits on the stoop in his coat with Mercy. Behind him, the house is dark except for Raven's window. Across the river, Manhattan.

MARC (V.O.)
We lie to protect people. We lie to protect ourselves. (beat) We lie because the truth will cost something.

Mercy rests her head on his knee.

MARC (V.O.)
But the thing nobody tells you is that a lie doesn't make the cost go away. (beat) It just lets it collect interest.

Raven's window goes dark.

MARC (V.O.)
And sooner or later, somebody always comes to collect.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x14

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

THE SMOKING GUN: "A MILLION LITTLE LIES"

Posted January 8, 2006

"Police reports, court records, interviews and other documents have exposed James Frey's memoir as a fabrication... Frey, whose book was an Oprah's Book Club selection, spent a few hours in a police station, not 87 days in jail..." (The controversy dominated the third week of January 2006.)

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "BIN LADEN TAPE WARNS OF ATTACKS, OFFERS 'TRUCE'"

Thursday, January 19, 2006

"An audiotape attributed to Osama bin Laden and aired on Al-Jazeera warned of new attacks on the United States and offered a 'long-term truce.' The White House rejected the offer..."

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Friday, January 20, 2006, 6:41 PM

"LIES, LIES, LIES. We're not naming names, but let's just say there is NO GYM ON VERNON and there is NO BALLY'S IN LIC. A certain someone has been 'at the gym' at 6 AM every day this week, and the gym has an IV pole. Pray for everybody involved. Truly. Also: an 88-year-old church mother who would only call one of our interns 'girl' all week signed out this evening saying 'Thank you, Dr. Divine' in front of the whole lobby. We witnessed it. We are not okay." Comments (2,607).

Letter: Whitaker, Stein & Adebayo, LLP (Chicago) to Dr. Robert Bullock

Forwarded by the Howard University alumni office; opened January 20, 2006

"Dear Dr. Bullock: We represent the Estate of Delphine A. Ware, M.D., who passed away in Chicago in March 2003. Among Dr. Ware's papers was the enclosed sealed letter, with written instructions that it be delivered to you personally 'once the estate is settled.' The estate was settled on December 30, 2005. We have not read its contents. Sincerely, R. Adebayo." (Enclosure: one sealed envelope, 'Robert Bullock -- Personal.' UNOPENED.)

Abyssinian Development Corporation: Letter of Tenancy

Friday, January 20, 2006

"Mrs. Henrietta Bolden is approved for a one-bedroom senior unit at West 138th Street, effective February 1, 2006, at a monthly rent of $312. Elevator building."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Raven Ellison to Dash Duvall)

Friday, January 20, 2006, 5:57 AM

Raven: "on my way. decaf."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x14

New Canon Established

- **RAVEN, DASH AND ARIANNA:** Raven has been visiting Dash at 6 AM every day this week (decaf; Glenda calls her 'the angel') and telling Arianna she was at 'the gym.' Elxa caught the lie at the board ('There's no gym on Vernon'). Charge nurse Yvette Banks told Arianna, thinking she knew. **Arianna took her things from 49th Avenue in a tote bag:** 'I'm not breaking up with you. I'm taking a step back.' 'Fourteen words.' 'He's a good man, Raven.' Raven to Dash, her one true thing: 'I come because I can't stand to start a day without seeing you.' Dash admitted part of him is glad. **Arianna and Raven are 'on a step back,' not broken up.**
- **Marc lied twice for Raven** ('coffee,' then 'coffee after the gym'). Amond: 'Stop lying for people. It's not your truth to hold.' Amond revealed that for six months after his father's crash his mother told their church it was a 'heart attack.' **Marc told Arianna the whole truth** in Stairwell B: Raven loves her, she's falling for Dash, and she's terrified that choosing either one kills him.
- **ROBERT AND DELPHINE WARE:** a letter from Whitaker, Stein & Adebayo (Chicago), forwarded by the Howard alumni office, enclosed **a sealed letter from the late Dr. Delphine A. Ware** ('Robert Bullock -- Personal'), to be delivered once her estate settled (December 30, 2005). **Robert has NOT opened it.** It sits in the glove compartment of his silver Mercedes. He told Natasha it was 'alumni fund' and then 'Howard alumni of Chicago.' Natasha noticed the Chicago postmark: 'Secrets keep you sick... it won't keep forever.' He wrote a $5,000 check to Howard's Louis Stokes Health Sciences Library in both their names. **Per MA-005, the Mariah reveal stays in Season 11. The letter must remain unopened on screen until then.**
- **Harmony and Mrs. Henrietta Bolden** (88): she was a domestic worker on Park Avenue for 41 years and called Harmony 'girl' all week. She faked chest pain for four days because she faces eviction from 141st Street (52 years there; a condo conversion; the marshal's date is January 26). **Celia Montague** got her a senior unit on West 138th Street through the Abyssinian Development Corporation ($312 a month, elevator, February 1), and Legal Aid is filing a stay. Henrietta: 'Thank you, Dr. Divine... Don't you let anybody call you anything else.'
- **Augustin's move** (Saturday, January 14, Halsey Street): Jerry and Ronnie carried the bed up four flights. Augustin set the hotel photo on the windowsill himself, made chicory coffee and handed Harmony hers last, saying 'Merci, Mademoiselle Divine.' Esther's reading: 'Last is I'm thinking about it.'
- **Elxa (37w2d)** has had low back pain every 15 to 20 minutes since noon. **Natasha took over the surgical board herself** until 7 PM and sent Elxa home to call Dr. Hampton and Russell. Natasha ran the board in 1990 for six months. **Esther told Clayton about holding Marc's hand** at the vow renewal ('No more Octobers'). Clayton: 'I'd rather be terrified with the truth than comfortable with a lie.'
- **Kennerly told a family the plain truth about a lung mass** (Gloria: 'He doesn't lie. Half the attendings in this building can't say that'); the grandson is flying in from Fort Bragg. **Graves apologized to a patient** for saying 'faking' (PNES): 'I learned something from an intern today.' Arianna's Pittsburgh past: her father's lie was 'the VFW' when he was really at the corner of Penn and Highland, and at 15 she lied about her age to get a job at the Eat'n Park on McKnight Road.

Lillian threw *A Million Little Pieces* in the trash.

Knowledge Tracker (as of January 20, 2006)

Item	Who knows
Raven's morning visits to Dash	Everyone, including Arianna
Raven's 'one true thing' to Dash	Raven, Dash
Delphine Ware's sealed letter	Robert (unopened); Natasha knows only that there's a Chicago envelope he lied about
Mariah Pettaway (Robert's daughter)	No one. Locked until Season 11
Elxa's early labor signs	Elxa, Natasha, Russell, Dr. Hampton

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Mrs. Henrietta Bolden	6/3/1917 (88)	Atypical chest pain (cardiac and GI workup negative); housing crisis	Social work intervention (Divine; Montague)	Discharged; senior housing February 1
Shanice Ward	8/22/1990 (15)	Ruptured right tubal ectopic, 7 weeks; claimed to be 18	Laparoscopic right salpingectomy (Hartwell; Cummings)	Stable; reconciled with her mother
Fulton Reese	9/1/1944 (61)	Three-vessel CAD, 70% left main; cotinine 1,200 ng/mL	Elective CABG postponed 4 weeks (R. Bullock; Baker)	Patch, bupropion, counseling; gave up 'the pack'
Tiffany Royal	11/13/1981 (24)	PNES (normal video EEG during events); childhood abuse	AEDs tapered; psychiatry (Graves; Smilley; Bynum)	Improving
Elderly lung patient (ER)	-	6 cm right lung mass, malignant effusion	Chest tube drainage (Kennerly)	Palliative; family gathered

New Characters

- **Mrs. Henrietta Bolden** (b. June 3, 1917), a domestic worker on Park Avenue from 1947 to 1988 who lived at West 141st Street from 1954. **Fulton Reese** (b. September 1, 1944), a retired Sanitation supervisor, and **Vernice** (b. April 4, 1946) of Springfield Gardens.
- **Shanice Ward** (b. August 22, 1990) and **Renee Ward** (b. March 3, 1967). **Tiffany Royal** (b. November 13, 1981), a home health aide. **Nurse Yvette Banks** and **Celia Montague, LCSW** make their on-screen appearances (in MA-005).

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- The Smoking Gun's exposé of James Frey's *A Million Little Pieces* was posted January 8, 2006. Oprah defended him by phone on *Larry King Live* on January 11 and confronted him on her show on January 26. A bin Laden audiotape offering a 'truce' aired January 19, 2006. Howard's Louis Stokes Health Sciences Library opened in 2001. The Abyssinian Development

Corporation operated senior housing in central Harlem. Eat'n Park is a Pittsburgh restaurant chain.

- Medicine: urine cotinine distinguishes active smokers (often several hundred to over 1,000 ng/mL) from passive exposure, and smoking cessation before elective CABG reduces pulmonary and wound complications. Kehr's sign (left shoulder pain from diaphragmatic irritation) suggests hemoperitoneum. A ruptured ectopic pregnancy is treated by salpingectomy, and a minor's pregnancy-related care is often confidential, though an emergency changes the clinical picture. Psychogenic nonepileptic seizures are confirmed by video EEG (no epileptiform activity; eye closure, side-to-side head movements and pelvic thrusting are suggestive), are not 'faking,' are strongly associated with trauma, and are treated with psychotherapy. A malignant pleural effusion is drained for palliation.